

Push Emails To Your Mobile As They Hit The Inbox

Internet-ready phones using push email technology make the world much simpler by putting emails just a click away!



■ SHWETA DHADIWAL BAID

Mobile email service 'push email' is common amongst business users, but with ease of operation, it has become popular for personal communication as well. Push email notifies you of the receipt of a new email in your inbox almost in real time. With this technology, you

are constantly updated of the activity in your mailbox, without you having to sign in.

You might not be aware of it, but every time you use a Web browser to log into your email account, you use a 'pull' technology to retrieve the new emails. In a way, you intentionally pull the information from the source. Imagine that you don't have to poll every now and then and the email automatically arrives on your mobile handset. This is push email scheme, where the mail is pushed through to the mail client without waiting for polling.

Introduced in 1998, BlackBerry original was the first personal digital assistant (PDA) to offer push email technology. "The concept of push email existed before BlackBerry, but BlackBerry was one of the first devices to make this technology popular on phones,"

shares Vikas Khandelwal, senior business strategy manager, Microsoft Exchange. "Today, almost every smartphone from HTC, Palm, Apple, Motorola, LG, Nokia and Samsung offers push email," he adds.

How push email works?

Push email works differently from pull email, and there are a variety of solutions in push email itself

that work differently for different phones.

Push email technology became popular as the 'BlackBerry technology' as BlackBerry brought it to common use. BlackBerry's proprietary push technology uses a network operating centre (NOC)—a server that sits between your mobile phone and the email server. "This represents the most battery- and data-efficient method for push email as the mail is forwarded to you only when there is a new one. In the absence of email, BlackBerry device works as a normal mobile phone," explains Satchit Gayakwad, spokesperson from RIM India.

The BlackBerry enterprise server (BES) integrates your corporate email set up by the IT in your organisation. Your IT administrator can control your account remotely. For individual users, BlackBerry Internet services (BIS) allow addition of up to ten existing email accounts. In BIS, BlackBerry registers with the mobile service provider that provides the wireless medium to forward your mails. You will get a specific BlackBerry email address as part of the plan or you can choose to have your current post-office file protocol version 3 (POP3) email sent to your phone.

Windows-based smartphones use hyper text transfer protocol (HTTP) request with a delayed time-out to check for changes on the exchange server. It directly talks to the exchange server, eliminating the need for the intermediate NOC or any involvement of the